UPSC CIVIL SERVICES · DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

WEDNESDAY, 28 OCTOBER 2026

19 must-know stories, 21 Prelims facts, 17 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 940 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

Open this brief online: summaries, Ask Intel and practice MCQs

MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

High Court Acting Under Section 11 Cannot Extend Arbitrator's Mandate Under Section 29A: Supreme Court

The judgment was delivered to resolve legal confusions regarding the correct judicial forum and procedure for extending an arbitrator's mandate. The Supreme Court clarified that a High Court exercising powers under Section 11 of the Arbitration and Conciliation Act cannot extend an arbitrator's mandate under Section 29A.

When: 2026-10-28 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** Core holding: Section 11 appointing courts lack suo motu or incidental power to extend mandates under Section 29A.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Prevents jurisdictional overreach by High Courts when dealing with routine administrative appointments versus supervisory extensions.; Enhances procedural predictability in Indian arbitration law by strictly adhering to statutory definitions of the competent court.*

Static — The Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996 is the principal law governing arbitration in India, based on the UNCITRAL Model Law. Section 11 of the Act provides for the appointment of arbitrators by the Supreme Court or the respective High Court. Section 29A prescribes time limits for making arbitral awards, mandating conclusion within twelve months from the completion of pleadings.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Appointment

Law Trend: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court seeks Centre's response to DNPA's challenge to DPDP Act

The Supreme Court issued notice to the Union government on a petition filed by the Digital News Publishers Association. The petition challenges specific provisions of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 and the DPDP Rules 2025. Publishers argue that the legislation lacks specific exemptions for journalism and threatens investigative reporting and press freedom. A bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana sought responses from the Ministry of Law and Justice and MeitY. The court declined to grant an immediate stay on the challenged provisions at this stage of the proceedings. The bench issued notice on the stay application, making it returnable by November 17, emphasizing the need to balance privacy and journalistic freedom. The DNPA petition, filed on October 6, requests the court to quash most contentious provisions before they take effect from May 2027. Senior Advocate Madhavi Divan argued that forcing reporters to seek prior consent from subjects would paralyze newsroom functioning.

When: 2026-10-28 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court, Digital News Publishers Association, Ministry of Law and Justice, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology · **Prelims:** The petition was filed by the Digital News Publishers Association on October 6.; The DNPA represents the digital arms of 21 news organizations.; The bench was led by Chief Justice Surya Kant, along with Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the ongoing judicial balancing act between individual right to privacy and freedom of the press.; Examines whether digital news media should be subjected to commercial data handling obligations like prior consent and erasure.*

Static — The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 provides a comprehensive legal framework for processing digital personal data in India while recognizing the right to privacy. The Act establishes the Data Protection Board of India to adjudicate non-compliance and impose financial penalties for data breaches. Freedom of speech and expression is guaranteed under Article 19(1)(a) of the Constitution of India, subject to reasonable restrictions under Article 19(2).

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

wionews.com: read the source · also reported by The Hindu, BusinessLine, Economic Times

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Upholds Workmen's Right to Claim Both Gratuity and Retrenchment Compensation; Section 25F(b) of Industrial Disputes Act, 1947, interpreted to allow dual benefits.

The Supreme Court delivered a ruling clarifying that workmen can claim dual benefits of gratuity and retrenchment compensation. The Supreme Court interpreted Section 25F(b) of the Industrial Disputes Act, 1947, to uphold the right of workmen to claim both retrenchment compensation and gratuity.

When: 2026-10-28 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** Section involved: Section 25F(b) of the Industrial Disputes Act, 1947.; Benefits concerned: Gratuity and retrenchment compensation.; Forum: Supreme Court of India.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces social security and financial safety nets for industrial workers facing retrenchment.; Settles legal ambiguity regarding the overlap of benefits under different labor statutes.*

Static — The Industrial Disputes Act, 1947, is the principal central legislation for the investigation and settlement of industrial disputes in India. Section 25F of the Industrial Disputes Act outlines conditions precedent to retrenchment of workmen, including the payment of compensation. The Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972, provides for a scheme of gratuity for employees engaged in factories, mines, oilfields, plantations, ports, and railways.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

Lawtext: read the source

Governance & Policy

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet Approves Rs. 7,395 Crore Pradhan Mantri Viksit Gram Swaraj Yojana to Strengthen Panchayats

The Union Cabinet approved the Pradhan Mantri Viksit Gram Swaraj Yojana with a total financial outlay of Rs 7,395.55 crore. The scheme aims to shift from traditional prescription-based schemes to empowering panchayats for decentralised planning based on local resources. It will run from 2026-27 to 2030-31, coinciding with the Sixteenth Finance Commission period. The Centre will contribute Rs 4,869.48 crore and states will provide Rs 2,526.07 crore towards the total outlay. Around 32 lakh elected representatives, panchayat functionaries, and stakeholders across more than 2.55 lakh panchayats will receive annual training. The programme supports the preparation of holistic Gram Panchayat Development Plans each year through the eGramSwaraj portal. It promotes transparency and better fund utilisation through online audits on AuditOnline and aims to boost own-source revenue. State governments and UT administrations will handle implementation under a Central Empowered Committee without creating permanent posts.

When: 2026-27 to 2030-31 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Ministry of Panchayati Raj, Ashwini Vaishnaw · **Prelims:** Total financial outlay of the scheme is Rs 7,395.55 crore.; The scheme will run from 2026-27 to 2030-31.; Central share is Rs 4,869.48 crore and state share is Rs 2,526.07 crore.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Empowers local bodies to design development plans tailored to local needs instead of following rigid top-down models.; Enhances financial transparency and accountability through digital portals like eGramSwaraj and AuditOnline.*

Static — Panchayati Raj Institutions in India trace their formal constitutional status to the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992, which added Part IX to the Constitution. The Act provides for a three-tier system of panchayats at the village, intermediate, and district levels across states. Article 243G empowers panchayats with responsibilities regarding preparation of plans for economic development and social justice.

Syllabus: GS2: Governance & Policy, History, Art & Culture, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Data/Stats, Scheme

BusinessLine: read the source · free copy on deccanherald.com · also reported by PIB, Business Standard, The Statesman, The Hindu, United News of India

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Khelo India Sports Goods Manufacturing Scheme for Building a Globally Competitive Sports Manufacturing Ecosystem

The Union Cabinet approved the Khelo India Sports Goods Manufacturing Scheme with an outlay of Rs 1,856.67 crore for the period from 2026-27 to 2033-34. The scheme was announced in the Union Budget 2026-27 to boost domestic investment, manufacturing, innovation, and exports in the sports goods sector. It aligns directly with the goals of Khelo Bharat Niti 2025, Make in India, and Atmanirbhar Bharat to position India in global supply chains. Dedicated Sports Goods Manufacturing Zones (SGMZs) will be created through convergence with the BHAVYA Scheme and NICDC industrial parks for cluster-based manufacturing. Anchor Investment Support and Turnover Linked Support components have been allocated Rs 1,130 crore to attract top manufacturers and expand domestic capacity. MSME clusters will receive assistance to modernise existing manufacturing facilities and build shared infrastructure and common facilities. An allocation of Rs 105 crore has been earmarked to help manufacturers acquire and renew quality certifications from international sports federations. Centres of Excellence and Anusandhan National Research Foundation convergence will support research in advanced materials, protective gear, and startup commercialisation.

When: 2026-27 to 2033-34 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports · **Prelims:** Total financial outlay of the scheme is Rs 1,856.67 crore.; Implementation period covers 2026-27 to 2033-34.; Allocation of Rs 1,130

crore is made for Anchor Investment and Turnover Linked Support components.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces import dependence on foreign sports equipment by scaling up domestic manufacturing and building local value addition.; Empowers MSMEs and creates employment opportunities through dedicated industrial zones and modern infrastructure support.*

Static — Khelo India is the flagship national program for the development of sports in India, aimed at mainstreaming sports as a tool for individual and national growth. The Union Cabinet is the chief executive body of the Indian government, led by the Prime Minister, responsible for aiding and advising the President. Atmanirbhar Bharat and Make in India are flagship government initiatives designed to facilitate investment, foster innovation, enhance skill development, and build manufacturing infrastructure.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy, Economy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

PIB: read the source · free copy on msn.com

GS2 MAKE NOTES

The concerns over the Census questions

The inclusion of identity and financial markers in the 2027 Census questionnaire has sparked debates regarding its scope and purpose. The upcoming 2027 Census population enumeration phase questionnaire includes 40 questions asking for sensitive details like bank accounts, mobile numbers, Aadhaar, and voter ID numbers. The questionnaire for the population enumeration phase of the 2027 Census comprises 40 questions and seek details such as nationality, number of bank accounts and mobile, Aadhaar and voter ID numbers, if available, raising concerns over its potential digression from the purpose of collecting data for policy and planning

When: 2027 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Registrar General and Census Commissioner · **Prelims:** The population enumeration phase of the Census involves a questionnaire with 40 questions.; The questions seek details including nationality, number of bank accounts, and mobile numbers.; Respondents are asked to provide Aadhaar and voter ID numbers if available.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the ongoing debate on balancing comprehensive data collection with the right to privacy.; Raises questions regarding the administrative scope and primary objective of the national census.*

Static — The Census in India is conducted under the provisions of the Census Act, 1948, which provides the legal framework for carrying out decennial population censuses. The responsibility of conducting the decennial census rests with the Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, which functions under the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India. Data collected during the census is strictly confidential and protected under the Census Act, 1948, ensuring it cannot be used as evidence in courts of law.

Syllabus: GS2: Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Report/Index

The Hindu: read the source

International Relations

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

India and Mexico launch Negotiations for Preferential Trade Agreement, Sign Terms of Reference

India and Mexico signed the Terms of Reference to formally launch negotiations for a bilateral Preferential Trade Agreement. The initiative aims to shield Indian exports like automobiles and textiles from high tariffs recently imposed by Mexico. Mexico imposed tariffs of up to 50 percent on 1,463 items from countries without a bilateral trade deal. Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal visited Mexico and met Undersecretary of Foreign Trade Luis Rosendo Gutiérrez Romano. The proposed PTA focuses specifically on preferential trade in goods to ensure quicker relief than a comprehensive FTA. In 2025-26, bilateral merchandise trade between India and Mexico stood at around 7.83 billion dollars. India exported goods worth 5.73 billion dollars to Mexico, with automobiles being the single largest segment at 1.92 billion dollars. The Mexico Plan launched in January 2025 aims to increase national content in production chains by 15 percent by 2030.

When: 2026-10-28 · **Where:** Mexico · **Who:** Rajesh Agrawal, Luis Rosendo Gutiérrez Romano, Narendra Modi, Claudia Sheinbaum · **Prelims:** Bilateral merchandise trade between India and Mexico was 7.83 billion dollars in 2025-26.; Indian merchandise exports to Mexico stood at 5.73 billion dollars in 2025-26.; Automobiles constituted the single largest export segment at 1.92 billion dollars.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Protects major Indian merchandise exports, particularly automobiles and auto parts, from severe tariff shocks in Mexico.; Strengthens bilateral economic engagement and diversifies supply chains between India and Latin America.*

Static — A Preferential Trade Agreement involves two or more partner countries reducing tariffs on a positive list of specified products. Unlike a Free Trade Agreement, a PTA has a limited scope and rarely reduces tariffs completely to zero across all items. Bilateral trade mechanisms like PTAs help mitigate risks arising from unilateral high tariff barriers imposed by trading partners.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: International Relations, Governance & Policy, Economy · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

PIB: read the source · free copy on hindustantimes.com · also reported by Economic Times

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Rajnath Singh, US War Secretary Hegseth review progress of 10-year defence pact

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh held bilateral talks with US Secretary of War Pete Hegseth to review India-US defence ties. The meeting took place in Cebu, Philippines, on the margins of the ASEAN Defence Ministers-Meeting Plus conclave. Both leaders discussed the security landscape of the Indo-Pacific region and the progress of a 10-year defence agreement. The discussions aimed to advance military integration, technological advancements, and bilateral defence cooperation. The meeting marked the anniversary of the ongoing strategic partnership between India and the United States. Both officials are in Cebu to attend the multilateral ADMM-Plus grouping meeting involving ASEAN and its dialogue partners.

When: 2026-10-28 · **Where:** Cebu, Philippines · **Who:** Rajnath Singh and Pete Hegseth · **Prelims:** The meeting took place in Cebu, Philippines.; Rajnath Singh and Pete Hegseth met on the margins of the ADMM-Plus grouping.; ADMM-Plus comprises 11-nation ASEAN and 8 dialogue partners.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights deepening strategic and military convergence between India and the US in the Indo-Pacific.; Reaffirms commitment to multilateral security frameworks involving ASEAN and its dialogue partners.*

Static — The ASEAN Defence Ministers-Meeting Plus (ADMM-Plus) is a platform comprising the 10-nation ASEAN and its eight dialogue partners. The eight dialogue partners of ADMM-Plus are India, China, Australia, Japan, New Zealand, Republic of Korea, Russia, and the United States. India became a dialogue partner of ASEAN in 1992 and participates in various security and cooperation dialogues in the Indo-Pacific region.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Defence · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

Hindustan Times: read the source · free copy on theprint.in · also reported by IANS LIVE, The Hawk

GS2 MAKE NOTES

[Answered] Does India’s public diplomacy on the Ukraine war erode its strategic partnership with Russia? Analyze the delicate imperative of multi-alignment.

The ongoing geopolitical tensions surrounding the Russia-Ukraine conflict and India's diplomatic positioning have brought the debate on multi-alignment into focus. This analysis explores how India's public diplomacy regarding the Russia-Ukraine war impacts its strategic partnership with Russia while maintaining ties with the West.

When: 2026-10-28 · **Where:** India, Russia, Ukraine · **Who:** Government of India, Russian Federation · **Prelims:** India maintains a strategic partnership with Russia.; India practices a foreign policy based on strategic autonomy and multi-alignment.; India emphasizes dialogue and diplomacy regarding the Ukraine conflict.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the complexities of India's foreign policy and diplomatic maneuvering in a multipolar world.; Demonstrates how India protects its core national interests, energy security, and defense needs amidst global polarization.*

Static — India and Russia share a long-standing Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership dating back to the 1971 Indo-Soviet Treaty of Peace, Friendship and Cooperation. Strategic autonomy is a core tenet of Indian foreign policy, allowing India to pursue independent relations with multiple global powers without formal alliances. Multi-alignment involves cooperating with various competing global power centers simultaneously to serve national interests rather than joining rigid blocs.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

ForumIAS: read the source

Social Justice & Welfare

GS2 MAKE NOTES

The NHRC, India issues an Advisory on the ‘Protection of Human Rights of Female Inmates and their Children’

The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) issued an advisory on the protection of human rights of female inmates and their children. The advisory emphasizes that female prisoners and their children form a vulnerable group needing focused, gender-responsive attention. It calls for humane prison conditions, adequate maternal and child healthcare, access to justice, and family preservation. The advisory covers ten broad areas including arrest and entry, admission records, child database, and mental health services. Other focus areas include living conditions, hygiene, legal aid, communication, rehabilitation, and foreign national inmates. The advisory has been sent to nine Union Ministries, Chief Secretaries, and Director Generals of Police of all States and UTs. The NHRC directed all concerned authorities to implement the recommendations and submit an Action Taken Report within two months.

When: 2026-10-28 · **Where:** India · **Who:** National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) · **Prelims:** The advisory focuses on ten broad areas including child database, medical care, and legal aid.; The advisory was sent to nine Union Ministries, Chief Secretaries, and Director Generals of Police.; Authorities are required to furnish an Action Taken Report within two months.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the often-overlooked vulnerabilities of women and children inside correctional and custodial facilities.; Pushes for systemic prison reforms by enforcing gender-responsive administrative protocols across all states and union territories.*

Static — The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) of India is a statutory body established on October 12, 1993, under the Protection of Human Rights Act (PHRA), 1993. The NHRC is mandated to protect and promote human rights relating to life, liberty, equality, and dignity of the individual guaranteed by the Constitution. The Commission consists of a Chairperson who has been a Chief Justice of India or a Judge of the

Supreme Court, and other members with knowledge or practical experience in human rights.

Syllabus: GS2: Social Justice & Welfare, Polity & Constitution

PIB: read the source · free copy on newsonair.gov.in

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Rs 10,000 Crore Scheme to Make India a Global Container Manufacturing Hub

The Union Cabinet approved the Container Manufacturing Promotion Scheme with a total financial outlay of Rs 10,000 crore for 13 years up to FY 2039-40. The scheme aims to scale up India's annual container manufacturing capacity from 70,000 TEUs to 7.5 lakh TEUs and reduce import dependence. It features four key components including Interest Subvention Assistance, Operational Expenditure Assistance, Testing and Certification assistance, and Land Leasing support. The Union Cabinet also approved the Khelo India Sports Goods Manufacturing Scheme with an outlay of Rs 1,856.67 crore from FY 2026-27 to FY 2033-34. The sports goods scheme will establish dedicated Sports Goods Manufacturing Zones and provide anchor investment support alongside turnover-linked incentives. Additionally, the Cabinet approved the Pradhan Mantri Viksit Gram Swaraj Yojana as a Centrally Sponsored Scheme with an outlay of Rs 7,395 crore. The rural local governance scheme will cover over 2.78 lakh rural local bodies and traditional bodies across States and Union Territories over five years. A 3 percent increase in Dearness Allowance for Central Government employees and Dearness Relief for pensioners was also approved, taking effect from July 1, 2026.

When: 2026-10-28 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw · **Prelims:** Container Manufacturing Promotion Scheme outlay: Rs 10,000 crore.; Khelo India Sports Goods Manufacturing Scheme outlay: Rs 1,856.67 crore.; Pradhan Mantri Viksit Gram Swaraj Yojana outlay: Rs 7,395 crore.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Boosts domestic manufacturing and positions India as a global manufacturing and export hub for containers and sports goods.; Empowers grassroots democracy by strengthening rural local bodies through the Pradhan Mantri Viksit Gram Swaraj Yojana.*

Static — Centrally Sponsored Schemes are implemented by states with central financial assistance based on a defined sharing pattern between the Centre and States. The Union Cabinet is the apex decision-making body of the executive in India, headed by the Prime Minister, responsible for executive administration and policy formulation. Dearness Allowance is calculated as a percentage of a central government employee's basic salary to mitigate the impact of inflation on the cost of living.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy, International Relations · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on newsonair.gov.in · also reported by PIB, BusinessLine, Business Standard

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Dearness Allowance to Central Government employees and Dearness Relief to Pensioners

The Union Cabinet approved the release of an additional instalment of Dearness Allowance for Central Government employees and Dearness Relief for pensioners. The hike is meant to compensate employees and pensioners against price rise as per the accepted formula. The decision increases the DA and DR rates by 3% over the existing rate of 60% of the Basic Pay or Pension. The effective date for this additional instalment of Dearness Allowance and Dearness Relief is 01.07.2026. The combined annual financial impact on the exchequer for this increase will be Rs. 10,016.10 crore per annum. The revision will benefit approximately 48.54 lakh Central Government employees and 68.71 lakh pensioners. The current increase follows the accepted formula based on recommendations made by the 7th Central Pay Commission.

When: 01.07.2026 · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, Central Government employees, Pensioners · **Prelims:** The DA and DR increase is 3% over the existing rate of 60%.; The revised rates are effective from 01.07.2026.; The combined impact on the exchequer is Rs. 10,016.10 crore per annum.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides immediate financial relief against inflation to millions of government employees and pensioners.; Involves a substantial annual financial commitment of over Rs. 10,000 crore by the exchequer.*

Static — Dearness Allowance is a cost-of-living adjustment allowance paid to government employees and public sector employees in India. Dearness Relief is the equivalent financial relief provided to central government pensioners to offset inflation. DA and DR are calculated as a specific percentage of a person's basic salary and pension respectively.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy

PIB: read the source · free copy on pmindia.gov.in · also reported by Indian Express, The Hindu

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Quick Estimates of Index of Industrial Production and Use- Based Index for the Month of September 2026 (Base 2022-23=100)

India recorded a 6.7 percent year-on-year growth in the Index of Industrial Production for September 2026. The growth was supported by a 7.6 percent increase in the manufacturing sector and an 11.2 percent rise in electricity and gas supply. The Quick Estimate of IIP stands at 124.3 for September 2026, compared to 116.5 in September 2025. The IIP growth rate for August 2026 was revised to 8.0 percent as a quick estimate. Mining and Quarrying sector registered a negative growth of 6.2 percent during September 2026. Within manufacturing, 17 out of 23 industry groups at the NIC 2-digit level recorded positive growth in September 2026. Top positive contributors included manufacture of motor vehicles, electrical equipment, and rubber and plastics products. These quick estimates will undergo revision in subsequent releases as per the official revision policy of IIP.

When: September 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) · **Prelims:** IIP growth for September 2026 was 6.7 percent.; Base year for the current IIP series is 2022-23=100.; Manufacturing sector recorded a growth of 7.6 percent in September 2026.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Serves as a vital macro-economic indicator for tracking industrial performance and manufacturing health in India.; Aids policymakers, economists, and central banks in assessing economic momentum and planning monetary interventions.*

Static — The Index of Industrial Production is a composite indicator that measures the short-term changes in the volume of production of a basket of industrial products during a given period. In India, IIP is compiled and published monthly by the National Statistical Office under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation. The base year for the current series of the Index of Industrial Production is 2022-23 (2022-23=100).

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Infrastructure & Energy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Report/Index

PIB: read the source · free copy on msn.com

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India only major emerging economy set to reduce debt ratio by 2031: RBI Deputy Governor

RBI Deputy Governor Poonam Gupta announced that India is projected to be the only major emerging market economy to reduce its government debt-to-GDP ratio by 2031. This projection was shared while addressing the Business Standard BFSI Insight Summit, citing October 2026 IMF data. India's general government debt is projected to decline from 84.3 per cent of GDP in 2025-26 to 75.1 per cent by 2031-32. Globally, public debt is expected to cross 100 per cent of GDP in 2030, with advanced economies' debt ratios worsening significantly. Gupta attributed India's favorable outlook to fiscal consolidation, strong nominal GDP growth, and a lower primary deficit. India's projected nominal GDP growth of 11 per cent annually outpaces the effective interest rate on government debt of about 7 per cent. General government capital expenditure has risen to 5.8 per cent of GDP in 2025-26 from 4 per cent in 2019-20. India's public debt is largely long-term, denominated in domestic currency, and held domestically, mitigating refinancing risks.

When: 2025-2031 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Poonam Gupta (RBI Deputy Governor) · **Prelims:** India's general government debt is projected to decline from 84.3 per cent of GDP in 2025-26 to 75.1 per cent by 2031-32.; Global public debt was 94 per cent of GDP in 2025 and is expected to cross 100 per cent in 2030.; India's nominal GDP growth is projected at around 11 per cent annually.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's economic resilience and fiscal prudence amidst a challenging global financial environment.; Demonstrates how sustained capital expenditure can strengthen growth potential and attract private investments.*

Static — Public debt includes all liabilities of the government, encompassing internal debt owed to domestic lenders and external debt owed to foreign creditors. Fiscal consolidation refers to the policies implemented by governments to reduce budget deficits and debt accumulation over time. The primary deficit is the fiscal deficit of the current year minus interest payments on previous borrowings.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on news.webindia123.com · also reported by Mint

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

UK CBAM: India seeks further talks ahead of January 1 carbon tax rollout

The upcoming January 1 rollout of the UK CBAM without exemptions for FTA partners put the issue in the news. India is seeking further discussions with the United Kingdom prior to the implementation of the UK Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism carbon tax. No exemptions for FTA partners like India; CCTS recognition subject to various conditions

When: January 1 · **Where:** United Kingdom and India · **Who:** India and UK authorities · **Prelims:** The UK CBAM carbon tax rollout is scheduled for January 1.; There are no exemptions for FTA partners like India under the UK CBAM.; Recognition of CCTS is subject to various conditions.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It directly impacts Indian exports of carbon-intensive goods to the United Kingdom.; It raises important questions about the interaction between bilateral Free Trade Agreements and unilateral environmental taxes.*

Static — A Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism levies a tax on carbon-intensive imports to equalize the price of carbon between domestic and imported products. Such mechanisms aim to prevent carbon leakage where industries relocate to regions with laxer environmental regulations. Free Trade Agreements traditionally reduce tariffs, but modern environmental mechanisms like CBAM introduce non-tariff carbon pricing barriers.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy, Environment & Ecology, International Relations

BusinessLine: read the source

Agriculture & Allied

GS3 MAKE NOTES

PM Modi to release Rs 18,680 crore under PM-Kisan scheme on October 30

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will release the 24th instalment of the PM-Kisan scheme on October 30 at a national-level event in Gujarat's Banaskantha district. The event is scheduled to take place in Bhildi town during the Prime Minister's two-day visit to Gujarat on October 30 and 31. The disbursement will provide over Rs 18,680 crore in financial assistance to more than 9.34 crore farmer families nationwide. In Gujarat specifically, more than 52.33 lakh farmer families will receive financial assistance exceeding Rs 1,051 crore. The Prime Minister will also lay foundation stones for two compressed biogas plants set up by Banas Dairy in Tharad and Radhanpur. Additionally, he will inaugurate the Bharat Bovine Breeding and Research Centre, a potato processing expansion project, and an automated storage facility. National Unity Day celebrations marking the 151st birth anniversary of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel will be attended by the Prime Minister in Ekta Nagar on October 31.

When: October 30 and October 31, 2026 · **Where:** Banaskantha district and Narmada district, Gujarat · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Agriculture Minister Jitu Vaghani, Banas Dairy · **Prelims:** The 24th instalment of PM-Kisan provides over Rs 18,680 crore to more than 9.34 crore farmer families.; Eligible farmer families receive financial assistance of Rs 6,000 annually in three equal instalments.; The Bharat Bovine Breeding and Research Centre was developed at a cost of Rs 328.77 crore.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides vital direct income support to millions of small and marginal farmers across India.; Promotes sustainable rural energy through the expansion of compressed biogas and Bio-CNG infrastructure from cattle waste.*

Static — The Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-Kisan) is a Central Sector Scheme providing income support of Rs 6,000 per year to all landholding farmer families across the country. The scheme is fully funded by the Government of India and has been operational since December 2018, transferring funds directly into the bank accounts of beneficiaries. Compressed biogas (CBG) plants use anaerobic digestion of organic matter like cattle dung to produce purified biogas, promoting green energy and waste management.

Syllabus: GS3: Agriculture & Allied, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats, Scheme

Economic Times: read the source · *free copy on ptinews.com*

Infrastructure & Energy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Green Hydrogen

India is projected to receive investments of $180 billion to $200 billion through 2030 to support its green hydrogen ambitions. Major barriers such as high production costs, limited commissioned capacity, infrastructure gaps and evolving international certification requirements currently hinder large-scale adoption. The push for green hydrogen is driven by the need for decarbonisation, export competitiveness, energy security, and producing low-carbon industrial materials. Sectors like steel, fertilisers, refining and chemicals are set to benefit from this green hydrogen push. Indian steel exporters face estimated costs of $70-190 per metric tonne on EU shipments under the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism, potentially exceeding $270 if default emissions apply. Green hydrogen currently costs Rs 350-450 per kg, significantly higher than conventional grey hydrogen at Rs 160-200 per kg. Costs are projected to decline to around $2.4 per kg by 2030 due to cheaper renewable electricity, falling electrolyser costs and project scaling. India consumes about 17-19 million metric tonnes of ammonia annually, which green ammonia can help replace to reduce fossil-fuel import dependence.

When: 2026-10-28 · **Where:** New Delhi, India · **Who:** CARE ESG Ratings Limited · **Prelims:** Green hydrogen costs between Rs 350-450 per kg while conventional grey hydrogen costs Rs 160-200 per kg.; India consumes approximately 17-19 million metric tonnes of ammonia annually.; Expected investments for green hydrogen through 2030 are estimated at $180 billion to $200 billion.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for India to meet its net-zero emissions target by 2070 and improve long-term energy security.; Mitigates heavy financial penalties on Indian exports like steel and chemicals under the European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism.*

Static — Green hydrogen is produced by splitting water into hydrogen and oxygen using renewable electricity through electrolysis, releasing zero greenhouse gases. The National Green Hydrogen Mission supports domestic manufacturing, production capabilities, assured industrial demand and credible international certification. The European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism imposes carbon-linked costs on carbon-intensive imports to prevent carbon leakage.

Syllabus: GS3: Infrastructure & Energy, Environment & Ecology, Agriculture & Allied

PIB: read the source · *free copy on ianslive.in*

Environment & Ecology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Heat-related deaths up 36% since Paris Agreement as climate action lags: Lancet

The 10th indicator report of the Lancet Countdown on Health and Climate Change found that health risks from climate change accelerated in the decade from 2016 to 2025. Global annual average heat-related deaths increased by nearly 36% in the decade since the Paris Agreement, with human-caused climate change responsible for over 70% of the 710,000 heat deaths in 2023. The core issue is that climate action has failed to keep pace with accelerating health harms, prompting calls to formally recognise climate change as a global health emergency. In India, people were exposed to over 2,600 hours per year between 2016 and 2025 where heat posed a moderate or higher risk of heat stress during outdoor physical activity, exceeding 1990s levels by over 200 hours. Indians also lost an estimated 64 hours of sleep annually due to high night-time temperatures between 2021 and 2025, about three hours more per year than the 1986-2005 average. The report notes that extreme drought affected nearly 52% of the world's land for at least a month in 2025, while very extreme rainfall reached 17.2% of global land annually in 2016-2025.

When: 2016-2025 · **Where:** India · **Who:** University College London (UCL), World Health Organization (WHO) · **Prelims:** Annual average heat-related deaths worldwide increased by nearly 36% in the decade since the Paris Agreement came into force.; Human-caused climate change was responsible for over 70% of the 710,000 heat-related deaths reported in 2023.; Global clean energy investment reached a record US$2.1 trillion in 2025.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the direct human and health costs of climate inaction, making a case for framing climate change as a public health emergency.; Provides empirical data on India's acute vulnerability to extreme heatwaves, sleep deprivation, and occupational health risks.*

Static — The Paris Agreement, adopted in 2015 and entering into force in 2016, legally binds parties to hold global average temperature increases to well below 2 degC above pre-industrial levels and pursue efforts to limit it to 1.5 degC. The Lancet Countdown on Health and Climate Change is an independent, international multidisciplinary research collaboration tracking the relationship between public health and climate change. Extreme heat stress during physical activity elevates risks of dehydration, heatstroke, and exacerbates underlying cardiovascular and respiratory illnesses, disproportionately affecting vulnerable populations like outdoor workers and the elderly.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU, Report/Index

Hindustan Times: read the source · also reported by UN News

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India releases Four Key Publications on Biodiversity Conservation, Biosafety and Access and Benefit Sharing at CBD COP-17, in Yerevan, Armenia

India released four key publications on biodiversity conservation, biosafety, and access and benefit-sharing at a side event during CBD COP-17 in Yerevan, Armenia. Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Shri Bhupender Yadav, today emphasised the need to translate global biodiversity commitments into effective implementation, sustainable financing and lasting conservation outcomes at a side event of the 17th Conference of the Parties (COP-17) to the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD) in Yerevan, Armenia. The event was organized by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Government of India, in partnership with India’s National Biodiversity Authority (NBA) and United Nations Development Programme (UNDP). The event was also graced by Mr. Hambardzum Matevosyan, President of CBD COP17 and Minister of Environment of

When: 2026-10-28 · **Where:** Yerevan, Armenia · **Who:** Shri Bhupender Yadav, Mr. Hambardzum Matevosyan, Dr. Taukondjo Shikongo, National Biodiversity Authority, UNDP · **Prelims:** CBD COP-17 was held in Yerevan, Armenia.; Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change is Shri Bhupender Yadav.; One of the released publications is titled Guidelines for the Designation of India's Other Effective Area-Based Conservation Measures (I-OECMs) 2026.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's proactive policy measures and reporting on international biodiversity frameworks like the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework.; Promotes sustainable financing, community livelihoods, and innovative conservation tools such as India's OECM guidelines.*

Static — The Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD) is a legally binding treaty for the conservation of biodiversity, opened for signature at the 1992 Earth Summit in Rio de Janeiro. The Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework was adopted at CBD COP15 in 2022, setting global targets to halt and reverse biodiversity loss by 2030. The National Biodiversity Authority (NBA) is a statutory body established in 2003 by the Ministry of Environment and Forests under the Biological Diversity Act, 2002.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, International Relations, Governance & Policy

PIB: read the source

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

EDUCATION AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Sports and Education Ministries sign historic MoU with UNESCO to take clean sport values to every classroom

The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, Ministry of Education, and UNESCO signed an MoU to introduce clean sport values in classrooms across India. The agreement was signed to promote integrity, fairness, and respect among school children using the 'Sports Values in Every Classroom Toolkit'.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

Union Jal Shakti Minister Launches Punah Bharan Mobile Application

Union Jal Shakti Minister C R Patil launched the Punah Bharan mobile application to help identify potential artificial groundwater recharge zones. The application was developed to support scientific groundwater recharge planning and sustainable management based on local conditions. It was developed by BISAG-N in collaboration with the National Water Mission under the Ministry of Jal Shakti.

PIB: source

ECONOMY SCHEME QUICK READ

Ministry of Textiles to Open PLI Scheme Portal for accepting new applications from 1st November 2026

The Ministry of Textiles is reopening the application portal for the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for Textiles under Round 4. The portal will accept new applications from November 1, 2026, until December 31, 2026. The core objective is to promote manufacturing in Man-Made Fibre (MMF) Apparel, MMF Fabrics, and Technical Textiles while boosting domestic capabilities.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY APPOINTMENT SPECIES QUICK READ

Dr. Dipon Sharmah Appointed to IUCN Species Survival Commission

The appointment was reported by Andaman Chronicle, highlighting the inclusion of Indian expertise in global conservation bodies. Dr. Dipon Sharmah has been appointed as a member of the IUCN Species Survival Commission, marking a significant recognition in wildlife conservation.

Andaman Chronicle: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION REPORT/INDEX JUDGMENT QUICK READ

Supreme Court allows petitioner seeking pre-loaded drop-down caste menu in Census to approach Registrar General

The Supreme Court refused to entertain a plea seeking the introduction of a pre-loaded drop-down menu for OBC castes in digital enumeration tools for Census 2027. The petitioner, OBC Federation of India, argued that manual caste entry should be replaced with a digital drop-down menu to streamline the process. The bench noted that the issue pertains to a policy decision best handled by administrative authorities rather than judicial intervention.

The Hindu: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES QUICK READ

New Cicada Species Neoterpnosia mawphlangensis Discovered in Meghalaya

A new species of cicada named Neoterpnosia mawphlangensis has been discovered from the semi-evergreen forests of Meghalaya. The discovery was made in the Mawphlang Hills within the East Khasi Hills district of Meghalaya. The species was found at elevations ranging from 1,378 to 1,605 metres in subtropical pine forests. It is distinguished from other species by characteristic structures in the male reproductive organs and markings on its transparent wings.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

ECONOMY AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

SEBI signs MoU with BoE on cooperation and exchange of information related to SEBI-recognised Clearing Corporations

SEBI signed a memorandum of understanding with the Bank of England to facilitate cooperation and information exchange regarding SEBI-recognised clearing corporations. The agreement establishes a framework allowing the Bank of England to rely on SEBI's regulatory and supervisory activities while protecting the United Kingdom's financial stability. The MoU enables both regulators to cooperate regarding central counterparties in line with their respective laws and regulations.

SEBI: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Union Government deputes High-Level Central Team to Investigate Death of Cheetah due to Firearm Pellet Injuries in Madhya Pradesh

The Centre deputed a high-level central team to investigate the death of a 19-month-old male cheetah from Kuno National Park caused by firearm pellet injuries. The cheetah was found injured on October 25 in the territorial forests of Morena outside Kuno National Park and later died on October 27 despite medical care.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | REPORT/INDEX | SPECIES | QUICK READ

Allocaecilius Nilgiriensis: Scientists Discover New Insect Species in Western Ghats

Scientists from the Zoological Survey of India have discovered and described a new insect species named Allocaecilius nilgiriensis. This discovery was made in the Nilgiri Hills, marking the second time a member of this barklouse genus is recorded in India. The new addition brings the total number of known Allocaecilius species worldwide to thirteen. The species is distributed across the southern Western Ghats in Tamil Nadu and Keralam.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

ECONOMY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Union Minister for MSME Shri Jitan Ram Manjhi releases Rs. 1,000 Crore Margin Money Subsidy under PMEGP to support 11,333 new Micro Enterprises across India

The Union Minister for MSME released Rs. 1,000 crore in Margin Money subsidy under the Prime Minister’s Employment Generation Programme. The funding aims to support 11,333 new micro enterprises across India through bank-sanctioned project loans worth approximately Rs. 3,260 crore. The initiative is anticipated to generate around 1.02 lakh sustainable employment opportunities, primarily in rural areas.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Hegseth proposes 'ambitious' U.S.-ASEAN defence framework at Philippine summit

US Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth proposed a new ambitious US-Asean defense framework during a meeting with regional defense chiefs in Cebu. The proposal aims to help the bloc navigate critically important years ahead by boosting regional defense partnerships. The United States seeks to uphold a free and open Indo-Pacific amid China's increasing assertiveness in the region.

The Hindu: source

DEFENCE | EXERCISE | QUICK READ

INS SAHYADRI ARRIVES AT BUSAN, REPUBLIC OF KOREA, FOR INDIA-RoKN BILATERAL EXERCISE

Indian Naval Ship Sahyadri arrived at Busan Naval Harbour in the Republic of Korea on October 26, 2026. The ship reached there to participate in the India-Republic of Korea Navy bilateral exercise. The visit aims to strengthen maritime cooperation and enhance interoperability between the two navies in the Indo-Pacific. INS Sahyadri is an indigenously designed and built guided missile stealth frigate of the Indian Navy.

PIB: source

HEALTH | QUICK READ

Union MoS Shri Prataprao Jadhav Launches Tobacco-Free Youth Campaign 4.0, Calls Upon Youth to Lead Nationwide Movement Against Tobacco and Addiction

Union Minister of State for AYUSH and Health and Family Welfare Prataprao Jadhav launched the fourth edition of the Tobacco-Free Youth Campaign (TFYC 4.0) in New Delhi. The 60-day pan-India campaign aims to prevent tobacco initiation, encourage cessation, strengthen enforcement of tobacco laws, and promote tobacco-free environments. TFYC 4.0 marks a significant expansion with universities and colleges emerging as a major focus area of this year's drive.

PIB: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Centre releases Rs 78 crore for senior citizens' welfare scheme

The Centre released Rs 77.98 crore in grant-in-aid for 755 projects under the senior citizens' welfare scheme for the quarter ending September 30, 2026. The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment disbursed the funds under the Integrated Programme for Senior Citizens, a component of the Atal Vayo Abhyuday Yojana. The financial assistance aims to strengthen service delivery, welfare interventions, and institutional care facilities for older persons across the country.

Economic Times: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | SCHEME | QUICK READ

ASEAN Special Envoy Concludes Humanitarian Mission to Myanmar

ASEAN special envoy on Myanmar and Philippine foreign secretary Ma. Theresa Lazaro will lead a two-day humanitarian mission to Myanmar starting Wednesday. The mission will include a trip to Myanmar’s Shan State and engagements in the capital Naypyitaw, though specific details of the meetings were not provided. Myanmar's army-backed government has not yet confirmed the trip and previously stated in August that a special envoy was no longer necessary.

The Diplomat: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Union Secretary Shri Sudhansh Pant Reviews Implementation of Welfare Schemes in Assam

Union Secretary Shri Sudhansh Pant reviewed the implementation of central social welfare schemes in Assam at a meeting held at Loksewa Bhawan in Guwahati. The meeting was attended by senior state officials including Ajay Tiwari and Pallav Gopal Jha. The Union Secretary emphasized a coordinated, whole-of-government approach with the Department of Social Justice and Empowerment acting as the nodal agency.

PIB: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED | QUICK READ

With reference to the AgriVoltaics World Conference (AWC) 2026, consider the following statements: 1. It was hosted in India for the first time. 2. It was hosted by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare. 3. The theme of the conference was Powering the

The event came into news through structured statements regarding its hosting arrangements and thematic focus. The AgriVoltaics World Conference 2026 involves key discussions on hosting details, institutional roles, and the core theme of agrivoltaics integration.

ForumIAS: source

HEALTH | QUICK READ

NPPA releases Revised MRP for 543 brands of Anti-Cancer Medicines; List to be updated on continual basis; New Prices Effective from November 9, 2026

The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority released a revised Maximum Retail Price list for 543 brands of anti-cancer medicines. The price revision follows NPPA's earlier announcement of Trade Margin Rationalisation for 137 non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs in public interest. The policy aims to curb excessive trade margins, lower the cost of cancer treatment, and improve patient access to medicines.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SPECIES | QUICK READ

New Electric Ray Species Discovered In Arabian Sea, Named Tetronarce Ramanamurthy

A new species of electric ray fish has been discovered from the deep waters of the southeastern Arabian Sea. The discovery was announced by the Zoological Survey of India as the first confirmed record of the genus Tetronarce in the northern Indian Ocean. Electric rays are slow-moving bottom-dwellers that live on sandy or muddy seabeds and can generate electric shocks ranging from eight to 220 volts.

NDTV: source

ECONOMY | AWARD | QUICK READ

National Startup Awards 6.0 Launched with Rs. 25 Lakh Prizes Across 20 Sectors

The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade launched the 6th Edition of the National Startup Awards, known as NSA 6.0. The awards are part of the Startup India initiative to recognize innovation, entrepreneurship, and strengthen India's startup ecosystem. NSA 6.0 aims to encourage participation from across States, UTs, and emerging entrepreneurial ecosystems in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov arrives in U.S. for G20 meeting

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar will visit the United States and the Caribbean for high-level multilateral summits and bilateral discussions. He will attend the G20 Foreign Ministers' Meeting in Atlanta, United States, held from October 30 to 31, 2026, hosted by US Secretary of State Marco Rubio. On the sidelines of the G20 meeting, Jaishankar will participate in a QUAD Foreign Ministers' Meeting and hold bilateral engagements with counterparts.

Hindustan Times: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 The SIR verdict, serious constitutional questions

The recent Supreme Court verdict on the SIR process brought the issue of electoral roll revisions into national focus. An editorial analyzing the Supreme Court verdict on the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls and the constitutional implications for voter rights. The top court must ensure fairness in electoral roll revisions

The Hindu

GS3 Clean air needs targets, timelines and accountability

Air pollution heavily threatens public health and economic productivity across India despite existing frameworks like NCAP and GRAP. The Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan rankings focus heavily on administrative activities, where actual pollution reduction accounts for only 2.5% of a city score. Lucknow annual average PM10 level declined from 253 micrograms per cubic metre in 2017-18 to 135, but it remains twice the national standard of 60.

Indian Express

GS3 On theatre commands, let's finish arguing, reach a settlement, before next crisis comes

Persistent debates and delays among stakeholders regarding military theaterisation put the reform in focus. The editorial argues for an immediate settlement on establishing integrated theatre commands to avoid delays before the next security crisis.

Indian Express

GS2 UPSC Editorial Analysis: The Structural Dimensions of Unrest in France

Recurrent civil unrest in France spans pension reform strikes, suburban riots, and public-sector demonstrations, pointing to deep-rooted friction points. The French Republic relies on a strict civic assimilation model, prohibiting official census data based on race or religion to prevent sectarian division. Post-war suburban planning led to banlieues that experience geographic and economic isolation, school overcrowding, and limited social mobility. Second- and third-generation youths in these peripheries report an identity deficit, leaving them susceptible to civil unrest or antisocial behavior.

Insights on India

GS3 When tiger reserve boundaries go wrong, wildlife and people pay the price

Karnataka decided to review and rationalise tiger reserve buffers through a technical committee following a decision by the State Board for Wildlife's Standing Committee. Portions of existing wildlife sanctuaries and national parks across Karnataka have been notified as tiger reserve buffers, causing confusion and management issues. Overlapping designations create administrative ambiguity regarding applicable rules, conservation priorities, restrictions on residents, and infrastructure clearances. NTCA guidelines state that buffer areas are peripheral to core habitats and do not hold the status of wildlife sanctuaries or national parks.

Deccan Herald

GS2 Undoing a 50-year-old damage to federalism

The article examines how the 42nd Constitutional Amendment of 1976 permanently centralised India's federal architecture. Indira Gandhi pushed the amendment through a self-extended Lok Sabha during the Emergency while opposition leaders were jailed. Acting on the Swaran Singh Committee, the amendment shifted subjects like education, forests, and administration of justice into the Concurrent List. It also inserted Entry 2A into the Union List, enabling armed forces deployment in states without request, and froze Lok Sabha seat allocation based on the 1971 Census.

Hindustan Times

GS3 Best of Opinion: New rules of cybersecurity must focus on speed, readiness

Published as part of the daily opinion compilation examining key economic, technological, and governance issues. An editorial review discussing the need for cybersecurity rules to focus on speed and readiness amid AI-driven threats. Today's pieces examine India's ethanol blending policy, Lula's fiscal challenges in Brazil, AI-driven cybersecurity threats, export competitiveness and a book on the integration of princely states

Business Standard

GS2 Saudi Arabia vs Houthi rebels: It's time to look beyond the US

The United States armed forces are tied up in the war with Iran, forcing Riyadh to find alternative security partners. An editorial discussing how Saudi Arabia needs to look beyond the United States for security assistance against Houthi rebels due to US commitments elsewhere. With American armed forces tied up in the war with Iran, Riyadh will have to look elsewhere for assistance against increasingly hostile Houthis in Yemen.

Mint

GS1 GS3 Workforce shake-up is here to stay. Brace for it

Microsoft has made a voluntary exit offer to as many as 60,000 of its staff, representing 27 per cent of its total workforce. The move affects employees spread across the US, Canada, the UK, and India, following an earlier voluntary retirement programme in July. The underlying reason for these massive layoffs is the advent of artificial intelligence, allowing companies to do more with fewer employees.

Indian Express

GS3 India's steel future depends on breaking its costly coal habit

The Draft National Steel Policy Vision 2047, released on October 10, envisages nearly tripling steelmaking capacity with coal-based blast-furnaces accounting for 55% of production. This coal-dependent pathway could lock in about $1.5 trillion in additional coking coal imports over the lifetime of the new plants. India currently imports 92% of its coking coal at dollar-denominated prices, with coking coal accounting for roughly 40% of the cost of producing a tonne of steel.

Economic Times

GS2 Keralam governor's vegetarian kitchen row in Lok Bhavan exposes India's food hypocrisy

A political controversy erupted in Keralam after newly appointed Governor Om Prakash Mathur enforced a strict vegetarian policy in the Lok Bhavan kitchen. Congress MP KC Venugopal, Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala, and CPI(M) secretary MV Govindan criticized the move as an infringement on Keralites' dietary freedoms and a Sangh Parivar agenda. The core debate centers on whether individual dietary preferences to consume meat and fish should override a governor's personal dietary aversions within a public institution.

ThePrint

GS2 The SIR and its error margin

It is in the news as a critical commentary on the electoral roll revision processes and voter verification safeguards. The editorial discusses the critical error margins in the Special Intensive Revision of voter rolls and the severe risk of disenfranchising living citizens. A dead voter left on the roll is a clerical error. A living voter who is struck off loses their constitutional right

The Hindu

GS3 Ethanol policy : Clarity is a must to facilitate transition

The Road Transport Ministry notified changes to permit flex-fuel vehicles designed for E100 nearly pure ethanol. Within 24 hours, the Petroleum Ministry stated there is no immediate plan to increase ethanol blending beyond 20 percent. The editorial argues that such conflicting signals create an embarrassing flip-flop and raise doubts about long-term policy. E100 adoption promises reduced crude oil imports, but it brings serious concerns regarding fuel affordability and infrastructure. Conventional petrol vehicles cannot safely use E85 or E100 blends unless specifically certified for them.

tribuneindia.com

GS3 Theatre commands aren't the answer to India's military problem. Joint planning is

The debate over Integrated Theatre Commands in India has been reignited by statements from Chief of the Air Staff Air Chief Marshal AP Singh. ACM AP Singh clarified that the Indian Air Force opposes permanently splitting fighter assets geographically. The IAF advocates for a tailored structure built around India's specific security requirements rather than replicating foreign models. The CAS stated that transformation of this scale should be implemented in phases to prevent operational readiness compromise.

ThePrint

GS3 One year of GST 2.0: How did State revenues fare?

The completion of one year of GST 2.0 prompted an assessment of its fiscal impact on State revenues. An assessment of state revenues indicates that while total State GST collections saw only a slight aggregate decline under GST 2.0, the impact varied significantly across individual States. The aggregate State GST revenue dipped only marginally but this hides an uneven picture for States

BusinessLine

GS2 ECI must explain procedural lapses

The Election Commission of India submitted an affidavit in the Supreme Court defending its consensus and unanimity behind decisions. The affidavit argues that intentions behind the special intensive revision and procedure changes were honourable and constitutional. The reply clarifies motives and states that suggestions, queries, or objections during deliberations did not count as decisions. It clarifies that letters by two election commissioners concerned an internal work order that was never implemented after a July 30 decision.

Hindustan Times

GS3 Hunker down: on Cyclone Arnab, its landfall

The successful disaster management and minimal casualties following the landfall of Cyclone Arnab. The editorial discusses how proactive governance and effective administrative measures helped keep casualties low during Cyclone Arnab. Proactive governance kept the casualties low after Cyclone Arnab

The Hindu

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Israel's 2026 Knesset Elections: Voting System Explained Israelis voted on October 27, 2026, in the first national election held since the October 7, 2023 Hamas-led attacks and subsequent regional wars. PM Benjamin Netanyahu faced a tight race against former IDF chief Gadi Eisenkot amid projections of no clear majority for any bloc.

Vajiram & Ravi

Tropical Cyclone – Definition, Characteristics & Disaster Management in India Cyclone Arnab is rapidly advancing towards the Andhra Pradesh coast and is expected to make landfall on Wednesday. The cyclone has been classified as a Very Severe Cyclonic Storm and was named by Bangladesh under the regional naming system.

ForumIAS

Green Hydrogen and India's Clean Energy Transition India is advancing its National Green Hydrogen Mission to achieve an annual production target of 5 million metric tonnes by 2030. Green hydrogen is produced using renewable energy through water electrolysis, splitting water into hydrogen and oxygen with minimal emissions.

drishtiias.com

Why a Congress X post targeting CJI sparked a row in Keralam and prompted a party apology Kerala Pradesh Congress Committee president has distanced the ruling party from now-deleted post that urged CJI Surya Kant to resign after the latter questioned meeting an INDIA bloc delegation, prompting a legal notice from Supreme Court Bar Association.

The Hindu

Cheaper toll plaza travel for local residents: How NHAI's new annual pass works The initiative is in the news as NHAI implements the new annual pass mechanism to address commuter grievances regarding local toll expenses. The National Highways Authority of India has introduced a new annual pass scheme to facilitate cheaper toll plaza travel specifically for local residents.

Indian Express

How El Niño fuelled Cyclone Arnab's rapid intensification Cyclone Arnab crossed the Andhra Pradesh and Yanam coasts early on Wednesday, October 28, as a very severe cyclonic storm. The storm strengthened rapidly due to warm seas, ocean heat stored beneath the surface, and low vertical wind shear.
outlookindia.com

EXPLAINED | Who Protects a Cheetah When It Leaves Kuno? The movement of reintroduced cheetahs beyond the boundaries of Kuno National Park into surrounding areas put the issue in the news. This explainer details the protection mechanisms, monitoring protocols, and wildlife management strategies deployed when reintroduced cheetahs wander outside Kuno National Park.
Open Magazine

Arnab smashes into the east coast: How cyclones are named The naming of Cyclone Arnab as it smashed into the east coast brought the tropical storm nomenclature system into focus. This explainer details the protocol and regional mechanism used by meteorological agencies to assign names to tropical cyclones hitting the Indian coastline.
Indian Express

Is India to Be World's Oil Refiner? India is emerging as a major global supplier of petroleum products, driven by advanced refining infrastructure and strong capacity. Rising domestic demand for transportation fuels, aviation turbine fuel, and petrochemicals primarily anchors India's refinery expansion. The debate centers on whether India can achieve global refining leadership while protecting energy security and long-term sustainability.
ForumIAS

Israel elections: Why Netanyahu was punished, but not rejected The piece was featured as an explainer following the Israeli elections. An analysis of the recent Israeli elections explaining why Benjamin Netanyahu faced voter discontent yet managed to retain political survival.
Indian Express

US image offers rare look at China's secret spaceplane. What is it doing in orbit? A newly released US intelligence report has provided a rare high-resolution satellite image of China's secretive Shenlong spaceplane in orbit. The image, captured in 2024 by a Vantor satellite from 90 kilometres away, shows a winged vehicle with open payload bay doors and another spacecraft attached.
theprint.in

How Serbia's student movement won national elections within two years The success of Serbia's student movement in national elections put the phenomenon in the news. An explanation of how a student movement in Serbia organized and won national elections within two years.
Indian Express

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- River Pollution, Causes, Effects, Laws, Judgments, Solutions (Environment & Ecology) Vajiram & Ravi
- China's Grey-Zone Warfare along the LAC: Challenges for India and the Way Forward (Internal Security) ForumIAS
- India's record bank cash surplus fades as RBI curbs rupee bets (Economy) Economic Times
- "Functioned as Constitutional judge, Not Kashmiri Hindu": Ex-SC Judge Sanjay Kishan Kaul on Article 370 verdict, personal heritage (Polity & Constitution) https://www.indiagazette.com/
- Scientists engage directly with farmers in Delhi's rural areas under 'Khet Bachao Abhiyan (Agriculture & Allied) PIB
- India's Semiconductor Industry: Mission 2.0 and Key Challenges (Science & Technology) NEXT IAS
- Indias New-Age Space Technologies (Science & Technology) PIB
- IMF agreement clears way for release of $900 million for Argentina (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- India's Cultural Consciousness and Knowledge Traditions Form the Foundation of Its Civilisational Continuity: Shri Gajendra Singh Shekhawat (History, Art & Culture) PIB
- Delays In Executing Arbitral Awards: Supreme Court Asks Law Commission To Study Enforcement (Polity & Constitution) LawChakra
- Haryana Includes Beekeeping Under Mukhyamantri Bagwani Bima Yojana (Agriculture & Allied) Drishti IAS
- Afghanistan Ranks Second-Worst Globally in Rule of Law Index (International Relations) KabulNow
- Centre Notifies E100 Fuel Rules, Sets Emission Norms, Clarifies Regular Car Limits (Environment & Ecology) India Today
- Bihar Approves Raiyati Land Purchase Policy 2026 (Governance & Policy) Drishti IAS
- Main negotiating tracks concluded for India-EU FTA, text undergoing legal scrubbing, says MEA (International Relations) https://www.indiagazette.com/
- India invites Pakistan, SCO countries for November Civilisational Summit (International Relations) CNBC TV18
- Audit of conservation impact at 58 Indian tiger reserves begins (Environment & Ecology) The Times of India
- Ocean's ability to absorb carbon is weakening as climate change intensifies, UN warns (Environment & Ecology) UN News
- Prime Minister shares Sanskrit Subhashitam emphasising on protecting and nurturing nature for the welfare and prosperity of all (Ethics & Integrity) PIB
- A desi AI kill chain? Indian military steps towards battlefield AI (Defence) Economic Times
- India to bring further amendments to National Anti (Polity & Constitution) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)

- IIP growth eases to 4-month low in September as mining output contracts (Economy) Economic Times
- Isro changes its playbook for NVS-03 mission: The crucial fix after NVS-02 failure (Science & Technology) India Today
- Need to balance right to free speech, privacy: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) Times of India
- Soldier Who Developed Rheumatoid Arthritis During Kargil Posting Under Operation Rakshak Is Entitled to War Injury Pension: Supreme Court (Defence) Law Trend
- Multiple life terms cannot run one after another: SC (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- Operation Trident: India's Biggest Strike Against Drug Cartels Yet? (Internal Security) The Hindu
- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh meets US, Japan, Australia defence chiefs: What India's Indo-Pacific push means (International Relations) Open Magazine
- India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor to Boost Regional Connectivity (International Relations) Drishti IAS
- IBC | Lender Influencing Corporate Debtor's Policy Decisions Is Related Party, Cannot Join CoC: Supreme... (Economy) LiveLaw
- The way out of the dangerous trap (Economy) The Hindu
- We are aware of everything, will decide: Supreme Court on Chief Election Commissioner row (Polity & Constitution) The Economic Times
- Hyper-technical objections on arrest can't be treated as automatic key to bail: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) Deccan Herald
- Centre violated direction for cadre review of CAPFs, says SC, asks proposal submission by Nov 30 (Internal Security) ThePrint
- India Weighs US-Style Frontier AI Safeguards As Government Prepares New Law (Science & Technology) NDTV
- Gene therapy offers to beat hepatitis B virus by muting its DNA (Science & Technology) The Hindu
- Government working on bill to curb child & revenge porn: Solicitor general in SC (Polity & Constitution) Times of India
- A new ore-der: Can India's Mineral Exchanges fix the price game? (Economy) The Hindu
- ED busts 'drugs for goods' network, says Myanmar suppliers paid through fuel, food (Internal Security) Hindustan Times
- Can't restrict veto to P5 in a reformed UNSC: India (International Relations) Times of India
- Rethink strategy, heavily regulate acid sale to curb attacks, says SC (Polity & Constitution) Times of India
- Parliamentary panel to examine integrity of national exams, need for reforms (Governance & Policy) ThePrint
- Rape Case Can't Be Quashed Solely On 'Settlement' Between Victim & Accused : Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) LiveLaw
- Sebi may ease extra disclosure rules for foreign portfolio investors (Economy) Economic Times
- eSanjeevani Crosses 50 Crore Teleconsultations as PM Modi Hails Telemedicine Reach in Mann Ki Baat (Health) eHealth Magazine
- Supreme Court terms cyber crime as digital dacoity, refuses consolidation of cases (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- India's Thoothukudi Mega Shipyard Picks Up Pace as Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal Meets HD Hyundai Chairman Chung Ki-sun in Seoul (Infrastructure & Energy) PIB
- Very severe cyclonic storm 'Arnab' begins landfall near Narsapur; Vizag battered by rain (Disaster Management) The Hindu

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 19 must-know, 21 Prelims facts, 48 in the news, 17 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Economy (9), Environment & Ecology (7), International Relations (6), Governance & Policy (4), Polity & Constitution (4), Social Justice & Welfare (3), Agriculture & Allied (2), Health (2), Infrastructure & Energy (1), Education (1), Defence (1). **Nothing today in —** Science & Technology, Internal Security, Disaster Management, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 2 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 2 · Political change in the neighbourhood: 1 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 1 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 3

Full text — 48 of 69 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — PIB 16, The Hindu 7, Indian Express 7, Economic Times 5, Hindustan Times 5, ForumIAS 4, Vajiram & Ravi 4, BusinessLine 3, ThePrint 2, Law Trend 1, wionews.com 1, Lawtext 1, Andaman Chronicle 1, SEBI 1

Built 04 Nov 2026, 00:02 IST by UPSC Intel. Notes quote the reports; check the source before quoting a figure in an answer.